Polity (GS-2) Mnemonic Sheet

67 mnemonics from the handwritten notes, in large type for the wall.

Teacher's and handout mnemonics are kept exactly as given. Mnemonics marked **own** were added where the material had none.

Last pages: cover-and-recall drills.

Constitution and Union

Constitutionalism, living Constitution, Union and its territory

DR FISC

Constitutionalism and Rule of Law
own mnemonic

Six features: **D**emocracy (periodic elections) · **R**ule of law · **F**ree media · **I**ndependent judiciary · **S**eparation of powers · **C**ivil liberties.

TA

Constitutionalism and Rule of Law
own mnemonic

Positive constitutionalism balances **T**yranny (too much power) against **A**narchy (too little).

SEE

Constitutionalism and Rule of Law
own mnemonic

Dicey: **S**upremacy of law · **E**quality before law · **E**qual administration through ordinary courts.

DPP

Constitutionalism and Rule of Law
own mnemonic

Exceptions to equality: **D**iplomats · **P**arliamentarians (Art 105(2)) · **P**resident and Governors (Art 361).

MAJOR WAD

Separation of powers, checks and balances
own mnemonic

Eight overlaps: **M**PLADS · **A**rt 372 · **J**udge-made law · **O**rdinances · **R**egulators · **W**estminster (minister is MP) · **A**dministrative adjudication · **D**elegated legislation.

SSP

Separation of powers, checks and balances
own mnemonic

Limits of strict separation: **S**pecialisation · **S**peed · **P**ublic interest.

CRJ-NQ

Separation of powers, checks and balances

own mnemonic

Checks in action: **C**ollegium / appointment · **R**emoval Art 124(4) · **J**udicial review · **N**o-confidence · **Q**uestion Hour · clemency (Art 72, 161).

CECU

Separation of powers, checks and balances

own mnemonic

Institutional checks: **C**AG · **E**CI · **C**VC (statutory) · **U**PSC. (The first, second and fourth are constitutional.)

DISCO

Critical appraisal of the Constitution; Ambedkar's warnings

own mnemonic

Why bulky: **D**iversity · **I**nstitutional details of administration · **S**ingle Constitution for all · **C**entre-State detail · **O**ne-fold borrowing (1935 Act) and no ambiguity.

BVBUC

Critical appraisal of the Constitution; Ambedkar's warnings

own mnemonic

Five charges: **B**orrowed · **V**erbose · **B**ulky · **U**ngandhian · **C**ontradictory (inconsistent).

CHE

Critical appraisal of the Constitution; Ambedkar's warnings

own mnemonic

Ambedkar's warnings: **C**onstitutional methods · **H**ero worship no · **E**quality contradiction (+ cultivate morality).

PAS

Constitutionalism in practice; interpretation and conventions

own mnemonic

Three cultures: **P**olitical · **A**dministrative · **S**ocial value system.

OPPHL

Constitutionalism in practice; interpretation and conventions

own mnemonic

Methods: **O**rdinary meaning · **P**reamble · **P**rogressive · **P**urposive · **H**armonious · **L**iberal.

PCKI

Constitutional morality

own mnemonic

*Significance: **P**rotects minorities · **C**hecks the high · **K**eeps the spirit alive · **I**nterprets rights expansively.*

ABJODDC

The Constitution as a living document

own mnemonic

*Seven features: **A**rt 368 · **B**asic structure · **J**udicial review · **O**pen texture · **D**PSP · **D**ifferent amendment procedures · **C**onventions.*

SETFG

The Constitution as a living document

own mnemonic

*Five drivers: **S**ocial · **E**conomic · **T**echnological · **F**ederal · **G**lobal.*

L-FEEHSS

The Constitution as a living document

own mnemonic

*Stage-3 rights: **L**ivelihood (Olga Tellis) · **F**ree legal aid (Hussainara) · **E**nvironment (M. C. Mehta) · **E**ducation (21A) · **H**ealth (Paschim Banga) · **S**helter (Chameli Singh) · **S**peedy trial.*

AINR vs AEDS

Union and its territory: linguistic reorganisation, small states, second SRC

own mnemonic

*Against: **A**dministration · **I**ntegration · **N**o secession · **R**egionalism. For: **A**dministration · **E**ducation · **D**emocratic participation · **S**ecular basis.*

DJF

Union and its territory: linguistic reorganisation, small states, second SRC

own mnemonic

*Order: **D**har (no) → **J**VP (not now) → **F**azl Ali (yes, with limits).*

AEG vs DIFNFA

Union and its territory: linguistic reorganisation, small states, second SRC

own mnemonic

*For: **A**dministration · **E**conomy · **G**rassroots democracy. Against: **D**efinition · **I**nter-state disputes · **F**ragmentation · **N**o human-development guarantee · **F**inance · **A**lternative (decentralise).*

SEDAL

Union and its territory: linguistic reorganisation, small states, second SRC

own mnemonic

*Way forward: **S**econd SRC · **E**conomic viability · **D**ecentralise · **A**ddress deficits · **L**ast resort statehood.*

DPD vs NFRP

Delhi statehood

own mnemonic

*For: **D**elay · **P**opulation · **D**emocratic accountability. Against: **N**ational capital · **F**inance · **R**esource dependence · **P**opulation argument stretched.*

SSPL

Ladakh: statehood and Sixth Schedule

own mnemonic

*Four demands: **S**tatehood · **S**ixth Schedule · **P**SC of its own · **L**ok Sabha seats (2).*

DCSLSC

Ladakh: statehood and Sixth Schedule

own mnemonic

*Way forward: **D**emocratic representation · **C**onstitutional protection · **S**trengthen Hill Councils (3Fs) · **L**ocal jobs · **S**ustainable development · **C**ontinued dialogue.*

Fundamental Rights 1

Art 12, reservation, Art 19, contempt, media, protest

EFERCC

Nature of Fundamental Rights; Article 12 (State), BCCI, sports law

own mnemonic

Categories in order: **E**quality (14-18) · **F**reedom (19-22) · **E**xploitation (23-24) · **R**eligion (25-28) · **C**ultural-educational (29-30) · **C**onstitutional remedies (32).

SFAP

Nature of Fundamental Rights; Article 12 (State), BCCI, sports law

own mnemonic

Four tests: **S**tatute-created · **F**inancial and administrative control · **A**gency of State · **P**ublic or sovereign function.

HDC-UL-BB

Affirmative action: meaning, approaches, case for and against

own mnemonic

For: **H**istorical injustice · **D**ivision of labourers · **C**aste-class overlap · **U**ntouchability persists · **L**abour-market dualism · **B**ridging law-fact gap · **B**enefits society.

IBMPCMC

Affirmative action: meaning, approaches, case for and against

own mnemonic

Objections: **I**njustice · **B**ias-hostility · **M**erit · **P**roductivity · **C**reamy layer · **M**ismatch · **C**lass-not-caste.

HELM-D

Beyond quota: Quota Plus, creamy layer, sub-classification

own mnemonic

Quota Plus: **H**andholding · **E**mployment off-farm · **L**and reform · **M**SMEs · **D**iversity index.

JEMS

Beyond quota: Quota Plus, creamy layer, sub-classification

own mnemonic

Davinder Singh limits: **J**udicial review · **E**mpirical data · **M**ust not alter Art 341 list · **S**ub-group cannot take everything.

SEBC-16-13-10

Dominant castes, Maratha quota, EWS, effectiveness
own mnemonic

Maratha numbers: **16** (2018 Act) → **13/12** (HC 2019) → **struck** (SC 2021) → **10** (2024 Act).

SAA-MRP

Article 19: rights, restrictions, inferred rights, defamation
own mnemonic

Art 19(1): **S**peech · **A**ssembly · **A**ssociation · **M**ovement · **R**esidence · (f gone) · **P**rofession.

SSF-P-DM-CDI

Article 19: rights, restrictions, inferred rights, defamation
own mnemonic

Eight grounds: **S**overeignty · **S**ecurity · **F**riendly relations · **P**ublic order · **D**ecency-morality · **C**ontempt · **D**efamation · **I**ncitement.

SPIP

Article 19: rights, restrictions, inferred rights, defamation
own mnemonic

Inferred from speech: **S**ilence · **P**ress · **I**nformation · **P**rivacy.

NVIJ

Contempt of court
own mnemonic

Issues: **N**emo judex · **V**agueness · **I**ntent vs effect · **I**nfallibility · **J**udge vs court.

HRA

Banning books, sedition, obscenity, film certification, Section 66A
own mnemonic

Obscenity tests in order: **H**icklin (1868) → **R**anjit Udeshi (1965, applied it) → **A**veek Sarkar (2014, community standards).

ICC-PI

Significance of freedom of speech; balancing; threats
own mnemonic

Significance: **I**nherent value · **C**ornerstone of democracy · **C**ommunity life · **P**rogress · **I**nnovation.

OPJMO

Significance of freedom of speech; balancing; threats

own mnemonic

Threats: **O**bsolete laws · **P**oliticians · **J**udiciary · **M**edia and publishers · **O**fficials.

CWAPIV

Press freedom, role of media, ownership, paid news, trial by media, commercialisation

own mnemonic

Roles: **C**ivic forum · **W**atchdog · **A**dversarial · **P**rotective · **I**nformation · **V**alue-setting.

EBCYGP

Press freedom, role of media, ownership, paid news, trial by media, commercialisation

own mnemonic

Sensationalism: **E**xclusives · **B**reaking news · **C**ommodification · **Y**ellow · **G**onzo · **P**ost-truth.

20-5-1-1-1

Media regulation, Press Council, FDI, suppression, IT Rules 2021

own mnemonic

PCI 28: **20** press + **5** Parliament + one each from **Bar Council, UGC, Sahitya Akademi** (20+5+3 = 28).

CRNM

Media regulation, Press Council, FDI, suppression, IT Rules 2021

own mnemonic

SSMI four: **C**hief compliance officer · **R**esident grievance officer · **N**odal person · **M**onthly report.

SELDUCL

Media regulation, Press Council, FDI, suppression, IT Rules 2021

own mnemonic

Issues: **S**afe harbour · **E**ncryption · **L**imited consultation · **D**elegated legislation · **U**nreasonable restriction · **C**ompliance burden · **L**egacy media overlap.

AAA-21

Right to protest

own mnemonic

Protest roots: **A**rt 19(1)(a) speech · 19(1)(**b**) assembly · 19(1)(c) association, plus Art 21.

HRA-P

Right to protest

own mnemonic

Case order: **H**imat Lal (1973) → **R**angarajan (1989) → **A**mit Sahni (2020).

Fundamental Rights 2

Arts 19(1)(g) to 30, Article 21, secularism, Waqf

EDS

*Art 20: **E**x post facto · **D**ouble jeopardy · **S**elf-incrimination (in clause order).*

Article 20: ex post facto, double jeopardy, self-incrimination

own mnemonic

PPPS

*Environment principles: **P**olluter pays · **P**recautionary · **P**ublic trust · **S**ustainable development.*

Right to clean environment and against climate harm

own mnemonic

LLNP

*Privacy test: **L**egality · **L**egitimate aim · **N**ecessity · **P**roportionality.*

Right to privacy, data protection, right to be forgotten, personality rights, digital access

own mnemonic

GCPRR

*Concerns: **G**lobal internet · **C**ensorship risk · **P**ublic records · **R**TI · **R**ewriting history.*

Right to privacy, data protection, right to be forgotten, personality rights, digital access

own mnemonic

NNS

*LGBTQ+ case chain: **N**ALSA (2014) → **N**avtej (2018) → **S**upriyo (2023).*

Autonomy: life partner, abortion, LGBTQ+ rights, Section 377, marriage

own mnemonic

OBJWP

*Undertrial causes: **O**verworked police · **B**ail ignored · **J**udicial pendency · **W**eak prosecution · **P**overty.*

Speedy trial, legal aid, undertrials, prisoners, custodial violence, D. K. Basu

own mnemonic

PAIPIMMLC

Nine steps: **P**olice ID · **A**rrest memo · **I**nform family · **P**olice diary · **I**njury memo · **M**edical check · **M**agistrate · **L**awyer · **C**ontrol room.

Speedy trial, legal aid, undertrials, prisoners, custodial violence, D. K. Basu

own mnemonic

MMAMV

Machhi Singh: **M**anner · **M**otive · **A**nti-social · **M**agnitude · **V**ulnerable victim.

Death penalty: rarest of rare, clemency, remission

own mnemonic

ILPM

Four rights: **I**nformed · **L**awyer · **P**roduced within 24 hours · **M**agistrate authority beyond.

Article 22: arrest and preventive detention

own mnemonic

ABRP

Safeguards: **A**dvisory Board (3 months) · **B**asis (grounds) communicated · **R**epresentation · **P**arliament fixes limits.

Article 22: arrest and preventive detention

own mnemonic

EPSR

ERP test: **E**ssential part? · **P**rotected sphere? · **S**ubject to limits? · **R**eligious or secular?

Articles 25-26: conversion, essential religious practices, shrines, temple management

own mnemonic

IFPMD

Importance: **I**ndividual freedom (Mill) · **F**airness (Rawls) · **P**eace · **M**odernity · **D**emocracy.

Articles 27-28, secularism, communalism

own mnemonic

NEFLD

Challenges: **N**arrow concept · **E**xtreme religiosity · **F**ailing institutions · **L**aw gaps · **D**evelopment gaps.

Articles 27-28, secularism, communalism

own mnemonic

MCSBZJ

Articles 29-30: minorities, TMA Pai, RTE vs minority rights, AMU, welfare schemes

own mnemonic

Six minorities: ***M****uslims ·* ***C****hristians ·* ***S****ikhs ·* ***B****uddhists ·* ***Z****oroastrians ·* ***J****ains.*

FGN

Waqf (Amendment) Act 2025 and nazul land

own mnemonic

Interim order: ***F****ive-year rule paused ·* ***G****overnment-land disputes to tribunal ·* ***N****on-Muslim members capped (4 and 3).*

DPSP and Duties

DPSP, Article 39(b), UCC, Fundamental Duties

NHRP-FTC

Notice · **H**earing · **R**easons · **P**ublic purpose · **F**air compensation · **T**imely · **C**onclusion (the seven safeguards)

Article 39(b), right to property, eminent domain, Property Owners Association (2024)

own mnemonic

Bodies and Commissions

NCSC, NCST, NCBC, NHRC, NCW, NCPCR, minorities, NIA

PM-HM-LS-DCh-LoP

NHRC selection panel = ***PM, Home Minister, Speaker, RS Deputy Chairman, and the two Leaders of Opposition*** *(six people).*

NHRC: composition, working, functions, role, challenges, failures, reforms

own mnemonic

MCSBZJ

Notified minorities: ***M****uslims,* ***C****hristians,* ***S****ikhs,* ***B****uddhists,* ***Z****oroastrians (1993) and* ***J****ains (2014).*

Minority rights in the Constitution; National Commission for Minorities

own mnemonic

Executive and Legislature

President, ordinance, Cabinet, Speaker, privileges, Parliament

SINE-LAPSE

Ordinance-making power (Article 123): conditions, limits, cases, trends, examples
own mnemonic

*Ordinance checklist: **S**ession off · **I**mmediate need · **N**o amendment of the Constitution / no FR violation · **E**ffect like an Act · **L**aid before both Houses · **A**pproval or lapse in 6 weeks · **P**resident may withdraw · **E**xpiry max 6 months + 6 weeks.*

Centre-State Relations

Federalism, legislative, administrative, Governor, fiscal, inter-State

EFWWA

Education · **F**orests · **W**eights and measures · **W**ild animals and birds · **A**dministration of justice

Legislative relations: Articles 245-248, concurrent list, interpretation doctrines

own mnemonic

EMERGENCY-REQUEST-TREATY

Parliament on State List (Arts 249-253), repugnancy, model laws, Farm Laws, assent to State Bills

own mnemonic

Art **249** RS resolution · **250** Emergency · **251** inconsistency (Union wins) · **252** States request · **253** treaties. Numbers run in order, so just remember what each one is for.

RSNP

Rajamannar 1969 → **S**arkaria 1983 → **N**CRWC 2002 → **P**unchhi 2007: the order of the four commissions

Challenges to federalism, emerging issues, reforms, commissions, overall assessment

own mnemonic

Cover-and-recall drill

Hide the right side. Say what each letter or number stands for, then check against the cards.

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TA	*Constitutionalism and Rule of Law*
SEE	*Constitutionalism and Rule of Law*
DPP	*Constitutionalism and Rule of Law*
MAJOR WAD	*Separation of powers, checks and balances*
SSP	*Separation of powers, checks and balances*
CRJ-NQ	*Separation of powers, checks and balances*
CECU	*Separation of powers, checks and balances*
DISCO	*Critical appraisal of the Constitution; Ambedkar's warnings*
BVBUC	*Critical appraisal of the Constitution; Ambedkar's warnings*
CHE	*Critical appraisal of the Constitution; Ambedkar's warnings*
PAS	*Constitutionalism in practice; interpretation and conventions*
OPPHL	*Constitutionalism in practice; interpretation and conventions*
PCKI	*Constitutional morality*

ABJODDC	The Constitution as a living document
SETFG	The Constitution as a living document
L-FEEHSS	The Constitution as a living document
AINR vs AEDS SRC	Union and its territory: linguistic reorganisation, small states, second
DJF SRC	Union and its territory: linguistic reorganisation, small states, second
AEG vs DIFNFA SRC	Union and its territory: linguistic reorganisation, small states, second
SEDAL SRC	Union and its territory: linguistic reorganisation, small states, second
DPD vs NFRP	Delhi statehood
SSPL	Ladakh: statehood and Sixth Schedule
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GCPRR	Right to privacy, data protection, right to be forgotten, personality rights, digital access
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OBJWP	Speedy trial, legal aid, undertrials, prisoners, custodial violence, D. K. Basu
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